Comment on Pre-Analysis Plan – #ManyDaughters

We would like to point out that our implemented analysis includes one necessary deviation from our pre-analysis plan: For Hypothesis 3, we pre-specified to use (roughly speaking) the share of female vs. male working hours for the parents within the household and calculate its absolute deviation from 1. This outcome variable does not allow producing a meaningful estimate for two main reasons. First, it implies that the same allocation of working hours leads to a different measure of gender equality depending on whether the female or male has the higher number of working hours. Second, the measure is infinity/missing once the male has zero working hours. Unfortunately, this issue only became clear to us shortly after submitting the pre-analysis plan. We therefore deviate from our pre-analysis plan in the following way: We construct the working hours exactly as pre-specified but instead of focusing on the share of female vs. male working hours, we use the absolute difference in female vs. male working hours as our outcome variable.

We also would like to make two additional remarks:

1. The provided data set pl did not include the variable pla0009_h although it was listed on paneldata.org as being part of the data set. We thus use variables pla0009_v2 and pla0009_v3 to construct pla0009_h ourselves.
2. When writing our pre-analysis plan, we did not consider that individuals may provide inconsistent responses for their year of birth or sex across survey waves. As a result, we did not specify how we deal with these cases. In our implemented analysis, we set the corresponding variable to missing if an individual provided inconsistent responses across survey waves.